

Runbook: Testing the Firebase-Distributed Lava Client Against the Thinker Network API

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Applies to: Client 1.3.11-1071 (debug `.client.dev` / release `.client`),
api-app 0.2.11-17

Purpose: Step-by-step procedure for an operator to verify that the Firebase-distributed Lava Android client can reach the live lava-api-go stack running on the "thinker" development host, and to read §6.AC search telemetry in Firebase Crashlytics to confirm or rule out the H1 auth-header-overwrite bug.

1. How the Client Reaches an API: Two Paths

The client supports two distinct ways to talk to a Lava API service. Both are discovered through the onboarding `ApiSelectionStep` screen (`feature/onboarding/src/main/kotlin/lava/onboarding/steps/ApiSelectionStep.kt`).

Path A — ON-DEVICE api-app engine (loopback)

The separately-installed `digital.vasic.lava.api` app runs `lava-api-go` as an Android background service on `127.0.0.1`. It exposes its per-install handoff key via a `ContentProvider`, which the client reads through `ApiKeyStore` and injects as the Lava-Auth header value **before** `AuthInterceptor` runs. The on-device engine advertises itself over mDNS as service type `_lava-api._tcp` with TXT record `platform=android`. When the `ApiSelectionStep` `ViewModel` scans via `LocalNetworkDiscoveryService` (Android `NsdManager`) it resolves this to `Endpoint.GoApi(host="127.0.0.1", port=<dynamic>)` with `platform="android"`. The subtitle rendered by `displaySubtitle()` reads "Lava API · Android device".

Path B — NETWORK-EXPOSED lava-api-go on thinker (LAN HTTPS)

The thinker host runs lava-api-go in docker-compose.yml with network_mode: host. It advertises two services:

- **Prod stack:** _lava-api._tcp on port 8443 — service instance name does NOT carry platform=android
- **Dev stack:** _lava-api-dev._tcp on port 8543 — likewise

When NsdManager discovers the thinker's _lava-api._tcp record, LocalNetworkDiscoveryService resolves it to Endpoint.GoApi(host="192.168.0.228", port=8443). The TXT record's engine=go attribute is used; because platform is absent (or platform=server), displaySubtitle() renders "Lava API · On this network". The operator taps this entry and the ViewModel runs an HTTPS /health connectivity probe; on {"status": "alive"} it persists the endpoint and advances onboarding.

A third section on the ApiSelectionStep screen ("Cloud / remote server") allows typing a custom https://host:port URL directly — useful when mDNS broadcast is not reachable across subnets.

Key difference for auth: Path A uses a per-install handoff key (Mechanism B). Path B uses the build-time UUID embedded in the APK at LAVA_AUTH_UUID (Mechanism A, injected by AuthInterceptor). The H1 hypothesis is that AuthInterceptor overwrites the Mechanism B key on Path A because both use the same Lava-Auth header field name. The Crashlytics base_url_host key distinguishes which path is actually in use when a 401 fires (see §4 below).

2. Self-Signed Cert Handling: No On-Device Trust Required

The thinker's lava-api-go stack uses a self-signed RSA-2048 certificate with SAN IP:192.168.0.228, valid to 2027-06-23 (generated by lava-api-go/scripts/gen-cert.sh).

The operator does NOT need to install this certificate on the Android device.

The Lava client routes all `Endpoint.GoApi` traffic through the `@Named("lan") OkHttpClient` binding defined in `core/network/impl/src/main/kotlin/lava/network/di/NetworkModule.kt` (lines 149–180):

```
@Provides @Singleton @Named("lan")
fun lanOkHttpClient(...): OkHttpClient {
    val permissiveTrustManager = object : X509TrustManager {
        override fun checkServerTrusted(chain:
            Array<X509Certificate>, authType: String) {
            // No-op: trust any LAN-side server cert
        }
        ...
    }
    ...
    .sslSocketFactory(sslContext.socketFactory,
        permissiveTrustManager)
    .hostnameVerifier { _, _ -> true }
    .build()
}
```

This client bypasses Android's `X509TrustManager` chain validation entirely — `checkServerTrusted` is a no-op. It also sets `hostnameVerifier { _, _ -> true }`, so the IP-SAN in the cert need not match the IP the client connects to. TLS encryption is still active (TLS 1.3); the relaxation is authentication only. This is the same threat model the codebase already uses for cleartext on LAN mirrors.

`app/src/main/res/xml/network_security_config.xml` line 37 explicitly documents this:

```
"The lava-api-go HTTPS path on port 8443 does NOT depend on
this section — that path is wired through the LAN-permissive
OkHttpClient and bypasses NSC's trust-anchor resolution
entirely."
```

Android's `network_security_config.xml` only controls cleartext HTTP for the legacy Ktor proxy path on port 8080. It has no effect on HTTPS port 8443.

3. Test Procedure: Firebase Install → Onboard → Search

3.1 Prerequisites

- Thinker prod stack healthy (verify before starting):

```
curl -k https://192.168.0.228:8443/health # → {"status":"alive"}
curl -k https://192.168.0.228:8443/ready # → {"status":"ready"}
```

- Android device on the same Wi-Fi subnet as thinker (192.168.0.x).
- Firebase App Distribution invite accepted; APK installed (digital.vasic.lava.client.dev for debug).

3.2 Fresh-install onboarding

1. **Launch the app.** The ApiSelectionStep screen appears: "Searching for APIs on your network..." (spinner + api-discovery-searching content-description node visible).
2. **Wait for discovery** (up to ~10 s). The thinker's _lava-api._tcp advertisement should resolve. Expected: "Found 1 API:" + a row showing 192.168.0.228:8443 / "Lava API · On this network".
3. **Tap the thinker row.** The row enters probe state (spinner on row). The ViewModel calls ConnectionService.isReachable against https://192.168.0.228:8443/health.
4. **On success:** Onboarding advances to the provider-selection step. On failure: "Could not reach this API: " appears. See §5 for thinker controls.
5. **Select at least one provider** (e.g. RuTracker or Rutor) and complete onboarding.
6. **Run a search.** Enter any query and submit.

3.3 Expected outcomes

Scenario	Expected result
Thinker reachable, auth correct	Search results appear
Thinker reachable, 401 returned	No results; §6.AC non-fatal fires in Crashlytics
mDNS not resolved	"No APIs discovered" — use Cloud/remote-server section to type https://192.168.0.228:8443
Thinker unreachable	Probe fails at onboarding; fix thinker stack (§5) before retrying

3.4 Auth status quick-check (adb)

While the device is connected via USB:

```
adb logcat -s LavaAuth:D ApiBackedTrackerClient:D  
SwitchingNetworkApi:D
```

Look for 401 responses and whether the logged endpoint host is 192.168.0.228 (thinker) or 127.0.0.1 (on-device engine). This confirms which auth path is active before checking Crashlytics.

4. Reading §6.AC Search Telemetry in Firebase Crashlytics

The client ships §6.AC comprehensive non-fatal telemetry. Every search HTTP failure calls

`SearchResultViewModel.recordProviderFailure()` (line 175 of docs/telemetry/2026-06-23-comprehensive-nonfatal-telemetry.md), which enriches the `ApiHttpException` context and forwards it to

`AnalyticsTracker.recordNonFatal()` → `FirebaseCrashlytics.recordException()`.

4.1 Crashlytics custom keys to inspect

Open the Firebase Console → Crashlytics → Non-fatals filter: `ApiHttpException`.

Key	What it tells you
<code>http_status</code>	HTTP response code. 401 = auth rejected by the server
<code>request_url</code>	Query-stripped URL path (e.g. <code>/api/rutacker/search</code>). Note: query params are redacted by <code>stripQueryForTelemetry()</code> (§6.H)
<code>http_method</code>	GET or POST
<code>base_url_host</code>	The host the client connected to. 192.168.0.228 = thinker; 127.0.0.1 = on-device engine; <code>api.vasic.digital</code> = cloud

4.2 Diagnosing the H1 hypothesis

H1 (HIGHEST priority): AuthInterceptor at core/network/impl/src/main/kotlin/lava/network/impl/AuthInterceptor.kt line 63 calls `request.newBuilder().header(fieldName, headerValue)` — `header()` (not `addHeader()`) **replaces** any existing value for that field. If the routing layer already set the per-install Mechanism B key from ApiKeyStore via `withAuth()`, AuthInterceptor overwrites it with the build-time UUID, causing the server's HMAC verification to fail with 401.

Crashlytics filter combination to confirm H1:

1. `http_status = 401`
2. `base_url_host = 127.0.0.1` — confirms the 401 is hitting the ON-DEVICE engine (which uses Mechanism B keys), NOT the thinker (which uses Mechanism A UUID)

If you see 401s with `base_url_host = 127.0.0.1`, H1 is confirmed: the on-device engine is rejecting the UUID because its `AuthActiveClients` list contains only the per-install key, not the build-time UUID.

If 401s show `base_url_host = 192.168.0.228`, the thinker stack is rejecting the UUID — investigate `lava-api-go/internal/auth/middleware.go` and whether `LAVA_AUTH_UUID` in the APK matches the value in `lava-api-go's .env`.

Note: Firebase Crashlytics has no server-side ingest API. The Go service (`lava-api-go`) emits errors to Loki/Grafana (OTLP pipeline) — not to Crashlytics. Server-side 401 causes will appear in the thinker's container logs (`docker logs lava-api-go`), not in the Firebase Console.

4.3 Crashlytics filter steps

1. Firebase Console → your project → Crashlytics.
 2. Switch to "Non-fatals" tab.
 3. Filter by issue title containing `ApiHttpException`.
 4. Open an event → scroll to "Keys" section.
 5. Check `http_status`, `base_url_host`, `request_url` as described above.
-

5. Thinker Stack Controls

LAN URLs

Stack	Base URL	mDNS type
Prod	https://192.168.0.228:8443	_lava-api._tcp
Dev	https://192.168.0.228:8543	_lava-api-dev._tcp

Health check commands (run on thinker)

```
# Quick sanity – no auth required
curl -k https://192.168.0.228:8443/health # {"status":"alive"}
curl -k https://192.168.0.228:8443/ready # {"status":"ready"}

# Container status
docker ps --filter name=lava-api-go --format "table {{.Names}}\n\t{{.Status}}"

# Tail API logs (shows auth middleware decisions)
docker logs -f lava-api-go

# Restart stack
./stop.sh && ./start.sh
```

mDNS advertisement verification (on device or LAN host)

```
# On the Android device via adb (requires network-tools or mdns-scan on host)
adb shell "getprop | grep nsd"

# On the thinker host (if avahi-browse available)
avahi-browse -r _lava-api._tcp
```

The docker-compose.yml uses network_mode: host so JmDNS broadcasts reach the LAN directly; no port-mapping is needed for mDNS to work.

Cert details

- Algorithm: RSA-2048
- SAN: IP:192.168.0.228
- Valid to: 2027-06-23
- Generated by: lava-api-go/scripts/gen-cert.sh

- No client-side installation required (LAN OkHttpClient bypasses validation — see §2)
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Source Citations (File:Line)

1. **Cert handling (LAN permissive OkHttpClient):** `core/network/impl/src/main/kotlin/lava/network/di/NetworkModule.kt:156–179` — `checkServerTrusted` is a no-op; `hostnameVerifier { _, _ -> true }`. The KDoc at lines 116–148 explicitly states the SP-3.1 rationale: self-signed LAN cert without device-side CA install.
2. **NSC does not govern port 8443:** `app/src/main/res/xml/network_security_config.xml:37` — Comment: "The lava-api-go HTTPS path on port 8443 does NOT depend on this section — that path is wired through the LAN-permissive OkHttpClient and bypasses NSC's trust-anchor resolution entirely."
3. **mDNS discovery → Endpoint.GoApi resolution + displaySubtitle platform discriminator:** `feature/onboarding/src/main/kotlin/lava/onboarding/steps/ApiSelectionStep.kt:337–346` — `displaySubtitle()` returns "Lava API · \$ {discoveredApiLabel(platform)}" for `Endpoint.GoApi`; `platform="android"` distinguishes the on-device api-app from the thinker network instance.